

Kevin Yang

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summary

Motivated to build products with craft and awe, to create at the intersection of liberal arts and technology, and to be in a state of relentless iteration.

Self-starter who has gone from zero robotics research experience to publishing papers and spinning out of MIT within a year, built a 130kw HPC cluster from scratch for vertically integrated research infra, started grant programs backed by Steve Wozniak and Tom Preston-Werner, built a flamethrower in the middle of the woods, and placed first in the world's largest hackathon hosted by NASA.

skills

Languages: Python, Rust, C, C++, Swift, SQL, Verilog, WebGPU, Assembly

Software: Control systems, distributed systems, real time graphics, full stack web apps, iOS apps

Hardware: Embedded systems, end mill manufacturing, FDM and resin printing, silicone injection molding

awards

Neo Scholar · Neo · Oct 2025

Slavin Fellow · Slavin Family Foundation · June 2025

Dean's List Finalist · FIRST Robotics Competition · April 2023

Finalist · Congressional App Challenge, Massachusetts's 4th District · January 2023

Global Winner · NASA 2020 Space Apps Challenge, out of 60k participants · Feb 2021

education

Harvard University · 2024–2028

Bachelor of Arts · Electrical Engineering and Comparative Literature · Cambridge, MA · GPA 3.78/4.00

- Co-chair of the STS Undergraduate Fellowship at the Harvard Kennedy School
- Board member of the Harvard Undergraduate Engineering Society

Newton South High School · 2020–2024

High School Diploma · Newton, MA · GPA 3.99/4.00

- Four year class president
- Mock trial captain, led team to two Massachusetts Final Four appearances
- Robotics team captain, led team to two World Championship appearances

experience

Neo Residency · June 2026–Aug 2026

Resident · San Francisco, CA · draw.pastel.design ☎ ☒

- Created Pastel, a digital design tool for making dynamic, animatable and interactive digital assets.
- Pioneered novel computational representations of strokes and blends (patent pending) based on signed distance fields and gaussian splats.
- Web stack written in Rust and TypeScript, compiled to WebAssembly, with a custom GPU renderer written in WebGPU and networking protocol in Protobuf.

FortyFive Labs · Sept 2024–Jan 2026

Founding Engineer · Cambridge, MA · fortyfive.ai ☎

- Started MIT spin out creating synthetic policy evaluation setups. Customers included Cobot, Amazon Robotics, FieldAI, Tencent X Robotics, and labs at CMU and UCSD.
- Co-led fundraising efforts, securing \$5M at \$35M post-money valuation. Investors include Calibrate Ventures, Toyota Ventures, and Samsung Next.
- Built a 130kw GPU cluster at colocation data center to support internal R&D and customer deployments. Created from scratch: specing individual machines, to architecting distributed system, and negotiating colocation deal.

- Helped hire and interview candidates to grow team to 15 members.

MIT CSAIL · Jul 2023–Sept 2023, Sept 2024–Feb 2025

Researcher · Embodied Intelligence Group · Cambridge, MA

- Conducted machine learning research by extending the capabilities of Neural Radiance Fields (NeRFs) for sim-to-real robotics applications.
- Constructed Neural Radiance Fields of Cambridge, MA for ML data set creation.
- Created data collection pipeline from video acquisition using 360° camera mounted atop a car.
- Programmed wrapper for Insta360 One X2 camera in C++ and Python.
- Supervised by Professor John Leonard and collaborated with Ge Yang and associate professor Phillip Isola.

Truffle AI · Jul 2024–Sept 2024

Design Engineer · Santa Monica, CA · truffle.net 🌐

- Designed and manufactured initial prototypes of Truffle-1, a consumer AI inference computer. Oversaw build out of first 100 initial machines.
- Setup in-house plastics manufacturing processes (silicone injection molding, resin and FDM) to rapidly iterate on the product feel and ergonomics.

Hack Club · Aug 2023–April 2024

Program Director · Burlington, VT · hackclub.com/onboard 🌐

- Created PCB grant program giving high school students \$100 grants to fund their circuit board designs.
- Given out 1000 grants out of \$100,000 grant pool.
- Pitched to and received endorsement from Steve Wozniak, Dean Kamen, and raised \$100,000 from program funders Tom Preston Werner and Eron Wolf.

Hack Club · Jul 2020–Sept 2020

Engineer · Burlington, VT · github.com/kvnyng/Orpheus-Leap-Micro ↗

- Designed Arduino based education board to make embedded programming accessible to high school students.
- Coordinated and manufactured 500 boards with overseas PCB company. Shipped the board to students in 28 different countries.

projects

E-Bike Chariot 🚲 · April 2024

Built a car sized chariot with top speed of 25mph. Able to carry three people. Pulled by e-bikes.

Wonderland Hackathon 🌐 🚲 · Feb 2023–Jun 2023

Organized Boston based hackathon supporting 30 different projects with 200 participants from 5 different countries and 8 different states. Raised \$55k from Hack Club. Led a team of 5.

Hot Dog Flamethrower 🚲 · Aug 2023

Created a flamethrower at a remote hackathon out of a toy guitar, a taser, and a bottle of sunscreen. Shoots 5 foot long flames.

abSENT ↗ 🚲 · Nov 2021–Sept 2023

Created iOS and Android app notifying students when their teachers are absent. Reached 1.2k users. Programmed Python backend featuring Postgres, Firebase, and an LMS API.

publications

Neverwhere · IROS 2026 · ziyc.github.io

LucidXR · CoRL 2025 · lucidxr.github.io 📄 ↗

Towards Mega-pixel Embodied Vision · CoRL 2025 Workshop · openreview.net/forum?id=mJeBaE1UaH 📄